

THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES

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EXTN.



PLEASE QUOTE JL:AM

11th. March, 1977

SCHOOL OF ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING.

Professor Melvin Ferentz,
Brooklyn College of CUNY,
Brooklyn, N.Y.
U.S.A. 11210

Dear Professor Ferentz,

A second meeting of UNIX users in Australia was held on February 18th. at the University of New South Wales, with an attendance of about 30 people.

During the six months since the first meeting, progress in adapting UNIX to our needs has been steady but, for the most part, not spectacular. With most installations being used to capacity, future progress will be very much tied to further hardware acquisitions. The news about UNIX is spreading and we know of several other University groups who are currently corresponding with Western Electric.

There was one item of business which will be of general interest. The Department of Computing Science at the University of Wollongong which possesses an Interdata 7/32 computer, has recently discovered the true path, and Richard Miller reported on his progress in adapting UNIX to run on their machine.

Stage One, to adapt the "C" compiler to produce Interdata object code has been successful, and apart from the compiler itself, the editor was the first program recompiled and put into service. In stage two the normal UNIX environment for user programs was instituted on a "simulated machine" running under the Interdata OS/MT operating system. Stage Three, which will eliminate the remaining vestiges of Interdata software, should be completed within about two months. The one really significant problem remaining will be how to liberate all those programs still written in Assembler. It therefore appears that UNIX may soon have a new claim to fame as a portable operating system.

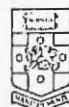
By general agreement the meeting was successful and the third of the series will be held in July or August.

Yours sincerely,

John Lions.
John Lions.

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Dear Professor Ferentz,

I wish to announce the existence of a detailed commentary on the UNIX operating system (i.e. the UNIX resident nucleus), which I have written and which should be of interest to many UNIX users.

The commentary was prepared originally to enable my students to use UNIX as an operating system case study, wherein the complete source of the resident code is investigated. The first version of the commentary is now being revised and extended and the second version will be issued in book form. The provisional publication date is May, 1977.

Details

There are two volumes of approximately 100 pages each. They will be produced by offset printing on size A4 paper after a 25% reduction from 11" x 14" originals printed on a computer terminal.

The first volume, "UNIX Operating System Source Code, Level Six" is an edited version of the resident code appropriate to a PDP11/40 with RK05 disks, PC11 paper tape reader/punch, LP11 line printer and KL11/DL11 terminal interfaces. A cross-reference is included.

The second volume, "Notes on the UNIX Operating System", contains a detailed commentary on the contents of the first volume. There are twenty-six chapters, including a review of the PDP-11 architecture, a tutorial in reading "C" programs, and some suggestions for student exercises. Two indices are included for reference purposes.

The cost for a single set (two volumes) will be \$10.00, plus postage. Postage costs from Australia based on a packet weighing 650 grams are as follows:

Air-mail (all countries) : \$A7.70

Surface Air Lifted (two to three weeks delivery time, to U.S.A.

UK, West Germany and Italy only) : \$A3.40

Surface mail (not recommended) \$A2.15.

I would invite anyone covered by a UNIX licence who is interested in obtaining a copy, to write to me as soon as possible so that the size of the print order can be determined. Prepayment is requested, with cheques made out to "School of Electrical Engineering, University of New South Wales". Currently, \$A1.00 = \$US1.10. A declaration that the recipient is covered by a UNIX licence should be included. Reduced prices for bulk orders should be possible if the total demand is large enough.

Yours sincerely,

John Lions.
John Lions.

\$14.75
US.